PHYS161 General Physics: Mechanics, Fall 2026

Synthetic syllabus for testing (not a real course page)

Lecture: 13:00 - 13:50 (MWF) PHY 1412

Office Hours: Tuesday and Thursday, 2:00-3:00 PM (PHY 1201)

Discussion: attend the section you registered for.

Quizzes

About 12 short quizzes will be given in discussion during the term.

Exams

There will be two in-class midterms and a common final exam. These dates are TENTATIVE:

Midterm 1: October 7, 2026 (Wednesday)

Midterm 2: November 18, 2026 (Wednesday)

Final exam: TBA

The final covers the whole course. Its date will be announced near the end of the term.

Exam Policies

Known conflicts: if you have a conflict with an exam date, tell the instructor in writing at least one week (7 days) in advance. Without notice, a missed exam counts as zero.

Grade Distribution

Final Exam - 35%

Midterms - 40% (20% each)

Quizzes - 15%

Labs - 10%

Topics

1. Vectors and Motion in One Dimension (1-2)
2. Motion in Two Dimensions (3-4)
3. Newton's Laws (5-6)
4. Work and Energy (7-8)
5. Momentum and Collisions (9)
6. Rotation (10-11)
7. Oscillations (14)